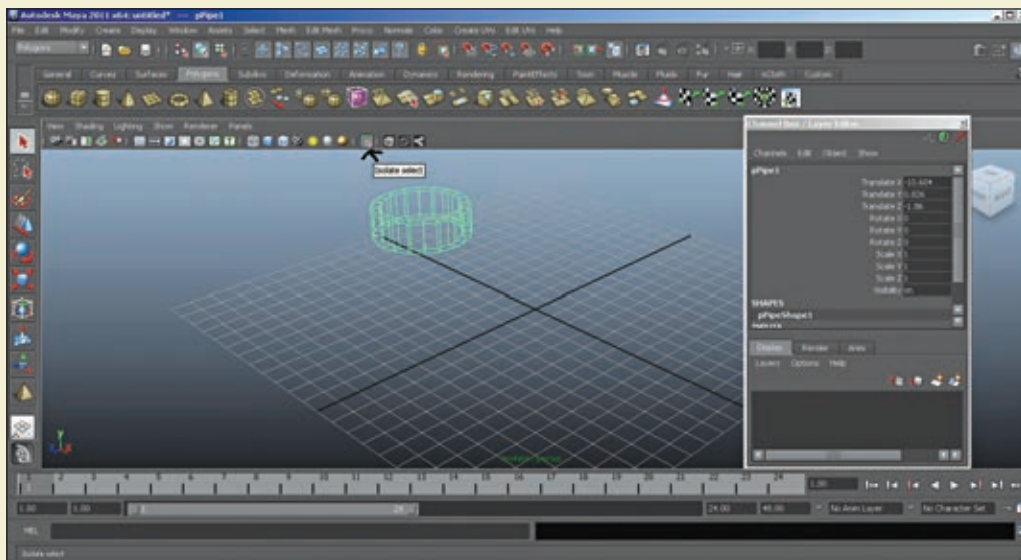




Isolate selected

Physical Sun and Sky. This will create the sun in your Maya scene. Add a couple of objects, a NURBS plane and sphere. You will notice a sky and sun which you can add objects and manipulate the intensity to get a very nice looking atmospheric effect.

Blur Camera

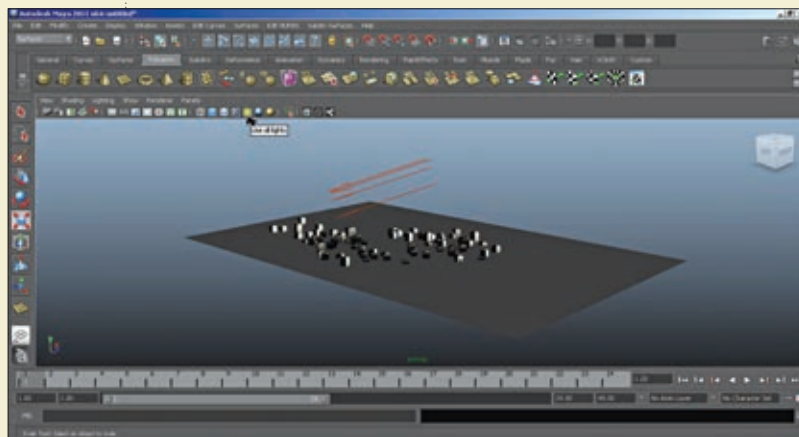
A good Depth of field always makes a shot interesting. To do this, select the Camera you are rendering from, then go to the attribute editor ([Ctrl] + [A]). Scroll down to Depth Of Field or even Z Depth. To blur objects in front of the camera, change the Focus Distance and the F stop. Try these values: Focus Distance = 100 F Stop = 25.

Isolate for easier work flow

One of the handy methods for a faster and easier work-

flow is to isolate objects and work on that bit and move to the next one. To do this, select the object, click the Isolate Select icon at the top of the viewport. The Isolate Select icon is a little select arrow with a green dotted line square that it's clicking.

Right above the viewport, it's the icon between the little gold ball and the grey 3D box with white lines. Click this icon again to see everything else in the scene. Isolating objects this way will not make them invisible when you render. To do that, you will need to hide them in the Outliner.



Lighting

More finite control over Scrubbing

If numbers or values change too fast while you're trying to modify them by scrubbing (dragging your mouse pointer over the timeline), hold [J] to make the tool work in a finer mode.

Lighting

A good and 'less processing speed' way for getting the lighting direction right is to turn the 'use selected light' button on.

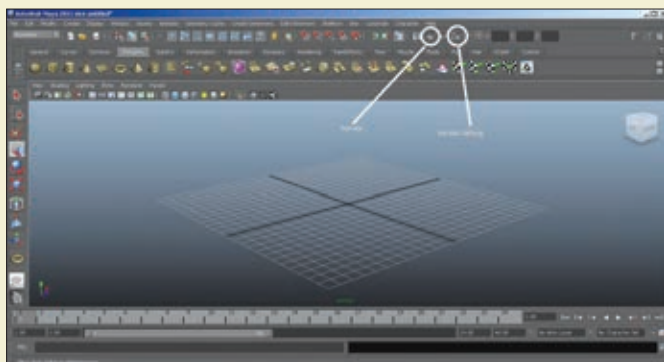
Quicker render

Rendering a full resolution image can be quite time consuming on a machine if you want to have a quick look for how your file really looks like. Here is a trick to see the renders on half or a quarter res or even

lower than that. Rendering > Render > Test Resolution.

These things always come in handy when you want to speed up your rendering capabilities.

- Remove unwanted objects in your scene.
- Try not to use Very High Resolution Textures for objects that are going to look really small in the shot. Same goes with Hi-res geometry.
- Keep proxy of Objects and textures
- Use instancing when necessary
- Use the Lights adequately. A number of lights can only make your shot quite heavy.



Change the "Render Using" from Maya Software to "mental ray"

- Don't overlap your 3D objects, at times, it will take more time to render than you can imagine.

Resources

A really good resource for getting some amazing maya (mel and python) scripts is <http://www.creativecrash.com> most of them are free. One can find anything from creating random rocks scripts to getting your interface to work according to your likes. Also, a good forum to ask any questions - Artistic or technical can be asked here cgtalk.com or cgtranta.com

Bonus tools for Maya http://area.autodesk.com/bonus_tools

These are a good bunch of plug-ins for maya which are not readily available within the software but you can download and